

# TOFU CHALLENGE

A B2B MARKETING HACKATHON FOR GOOD

## [TEAM NUMBER 6] SUBMISSION

**Team Members:** Daniel, Becca, Delaney, Shivani

**Challenge Statement:** Thorn needs to drive new donors who have the capacity to give more than \$1000 annually in order to fund their mission and protect children. We need your help to design a campaign strategy to identify and convert our target audience into engaged email subscribers and donors. To achieve success, you will need to bring this audience:

**From:**

- Mildly aware of the issue
- Unaware of Thorn

**To:**

- Caring about this issue space
- Believing that Thorn is well positioned to make a difference
- Willing to support Thorn financially

---

## KEY MESSAGES

Outline the main messages that will be communicated across the campaign.

**Primary Message:** *(The one key takeaway your audience should remember.)*

The **Digital Guardians: Defenders of Joy** campaign extends the existing messaging of the donation experience to reach an emerging audience of young professionals. It positions donors as protectors of childhood happiness in the digital age, emphasizing how their contributions enable Thorn's technology to safeguard the carefree exploration and wonder of youth online. The core message is that **Every child deserves a joyful, worry-free online experience: Your donation powers the technology that keeps digital spaces safe.**

**Supporting Messages:** *(Additional points that reinforce the primary message.)*

1. Build on the loyalty/advocacy loop by challenging existing donors to participate in a "Moments of Joy" Challenge where they share their own childhood memories of carefree play and we talk about how to preserve those ideas in the digital age.
2. Emphasize the direct link between donor contributions and these positive outcomes by providing regular updates featuring stories of children who can now safely enjoy online spaces.
3. Showcase the growing community of supporters. Donors can create their own "Digital Guardian" avatar to use on social media profiles to help drive awareness for Thorn

**Tone & Style:** *(What is the personality of your campaign? E.g., Informative, Inspirational, Playful.)*

- Optimistic, hopeful, blue skies, open spaces. Focused on amplification of good.
- Vibrant, optimistic color palette with blues and yellows prominently featured
- Illustrations of diverse children engaged in joyful online activities (gaming, learning, connecting with friends)
- Stylized "guardian" figures represented by ordinary people using technology
- Infographics showing the impact of donations on child safety metrics
- Incorporating humor into Thorn's online safety campaign can make the message more engaging and accessible. For example "LOL (Lots of Layers) Security: Keeping Kids Safe Online" and "Cyber Superheroes: Protecting Kids Online"

**Call-to-Action (CTA):** *(What specific action do you want your audience to take?)*

**Join our league of Digital Guardians - everyday heroes protecting childhood wonder.**

## CAMPAIGN ARC

Describe the overarching narrative of your campaign and how it unfolds over time.

**Objective:** *(What is the primary goal of this campaign?)*

The campaign positions Thorn's specific mission around protecting children online within the larger context of creating a more ethical digital world. It appeals to tech professionals' desire to influence positive change in their industry while offering concrete ways to make immediate impact by donating to support Thorn's mission.

**Target Audience:** *(Who are you targeting? Include demographics, and relevant campaign targeting criteria.)*

An emerging market of young, tech-savvy future donors who are actively online (social media and streaming platforms) and care about making the Internet safer for everyone. This is a mature, socially conscious audience.

They engage in online communities and discussions about technology and its impact on society, thus making them more likely to support social causes and donate to nonprofits. They value social responsibility and ethical technology use and are interested in cybersecurity, digital privacy, and ethical tech practices.

They earn middle to upper-middle-class incomes, with disposable income for charitable giving. They are influential within professional networks and have decision-making power in their organizations. They are highly educated and technically literate, staying updated on technology trends and impacts.

### **Demographics:**

- Age: 25-45 years old
- Gender: All genders, with a slight skew towards recently married/young parents
- Income: Middle to upper-middle class (\$200k-\$500k annual household income)
- Education: College educated or higher
- Location: Urban and suburban areas based primarily on the coasts (NY/SF/London)

### **Targeting criteria:**

- Follows technology news, podcasts, and influencers that discuss implications of digital technology on society
- Engages with online communities and discussions about technology and its impact on society, particularly Twitch, Reddit, Discord, Slack

- Has a history of donating to child-focused or technology-related charities
- Searches for information about ethical tech development, responsible technology use, digital wellness, and safe online spaces: social media impact on mental health, ethical AI development, AI bias, environmental impact of data centers, mindful technology use, digital detox methods, age-appropriate tech guidelines, online safety tools for kids, digital parenting, big tech ethical practices
- Likely buyers of premium technology products, e.g. headphones, building their own computers, ergonomic and standing desks/chairs, gaming hardware
- Listen to podcasts that provide downloads on news and technology, such as The Daily, Pivot, Hard Fork, Morning Brew, 99% Invisible, Hidden Brain
- Potential job titles (LinkedIn): Traditional tech roles (software engineers, developers, UX/UI design, Data Scientists and Analysts, Cybersecurity Specialists, IT Project Managers, Cloud Computing Engineers); Admins for Shopify accounts

**Core Message:** *(What is the main takeaway for your audience?)*

Every child deserves a joyful, worry-free online experience: **Your donation powers the technology that keeps digital spaces safe for exploration and growth.**

**Phases of the Campaign:** *(Break down the campaign into stages, e.g., Awareness, Engagement, Conversion, Retention.)*

**Phase 1: Awareness** - Introduce the concept of Digital Guardians and educate the target audience about Thorn's mission. Build excitement towards Safer Internet Day and Charity Streams; promote a landing page with links to influencer streams.

**Phase 2: Engagement** - Encourage interaction with the campaign and build a community of potential Digital Guardians: Moments of Joy campaign, interactive Guardian Gallery to generate avatars, email nurture content series showcasing the positive outcomes and success stories

**Phase 3: Conversion** - Transform engaged audience members into donors and active Digital Guardians; Digital donation drive through charity livestreams, driving to website for more information about the program, access to research, options to donate

**Phase 4: Retention (Ongoing)** - Maintain donor engagement and encourage long-term commitment to the Digital Guardian community

# CHANNEL STRATEGY

Detail how you will distribute your campaign across different marketing channels.

**Primary Channels:** *(Which platforms and mediums will you use? E.g., Social Media, Email, Paid Ads, Events.)*

**Streaming Influencers:** Twitch and YouTube influencers, particularly gaming streamers with audiences aligned to our target market

- Target a variety of influencers that cater across different age groups and interests but are all passionate about keeping their online communities safe
- Boys and girls are exploited differently so the methods promoted by the creator need to reflect their typical demographic
- Elementary-middle school age
  - Sesame St YouTube/Social Media
  - Pokemon (PokeRev/DeepPocket Monster)
  - Creators who are families with a young daughter (Everly Rose)
  - Creators who are families with young sons (Outdoor Boys)
  - Art (Sandra Cries Art - Spanish speaking audience)
- High school age
  - Gamers who are teenagers or in their early 20s (Dream, Jynxzi)
  - Fashion/beauty tutorials
  - Mental wellness/fitness/yoga/lifestyle creators that are meant for beginners
- Adults
  - Gamers who are in their mid-late 20s and up (Caedrel, xQc)
  - Mental wellness/fitness/yoga/lifestyle creators that are meant for experienced people
  - Podcasts

**Social media:** LinkedIn, BlueSky, Instagram - visually striking social media campaign using vibrant blue and yellow color scheme; a series of short, animated videos explaining the concept of Digital Guardians and their role in protecting childhood joy online; sponsored content in feeds, inMail campaigns, sponsored hashtags, pre-roll and mid-roll ads on tech-related content; sponsored newsletters

**Paid Media:** partner with tech influencers and podcasts (e.g. Hard Fork, Pivot) to discuss digital safety for children with custom ad reads by hosts for authenticity; develop targeted ads for professional networks and tech forums highlighting the importance of safe digital spaces for children

**Google Ads:** Search ads targeting relevant keywords (e.g., "online child safety", "ethical

tech"); Display network ads on tech-focused websites

**Co-marketing:** Companies that connect nonprofits with donors through corporate giving programs, sometimes offering the ability to have employee contributions matched by employers (e.g. Benevity)

- **Joint Email Campaigns:** Collaborate with corporate partners to send co-branded emails showcasing shared values and initiatives.
- **Targeted Outreach:** Use email to connect with corporate decision-makers, highlighting mutual benefits and partnership opportunities.
- **Internal Newsletters:** Work with partners to feature Thorn's mission and volunteer opportunities in their employee newsletters.
- **Volunteer Invitations:** Send emails to corporate employees inviting them to participate in Thorn's volunteer programs.
- **Recognition Emails:** Highlight employee contributions to Thorn's initiatives through dedicated email shout-outs.
- **Impact Updates:** Regularly send emails detailing the outcomes of corporate partnerships, showcasing tangible impacts.

**Email:** Nurture individuals who participate in each stage of the campaign towards becoming a Digital Guardian by signing up for a monthly donation; keep them engaged by sharing how their donation is having a positive impact

**Off-Site SEO:** Initial backlink audit from SEO tools shows that many of the following domains link to other websites competing for the same keywords and queries. Securing sponsored content and encouraging their staff to link to pre-existing high-quality research from the Thorn site will increase SEO ranking over time.

- univision.com
- wltx.com
- wishtv.com
- wtol.com
- kiiiitv.com
- freerepublic.com
- democraticunderground.com

**On-Site SEO:** Initial keyword gap audit shows that Thorn ranks very low for commonly searched terms such as "report blackmail online" or "online blackmail help." Consider publishing content that can serve as a step-by-step guide for those who need it immediately to improve SEO ranking over time.

## **Why These Channels?** *(Explain how they align with your audience and campaign goals.)*

### **Streaming Influencers**

- Well-marketed charity events specifically in the streaming space have a track record of generating millions of dollars
  - Games Done Quick: \$54,661,724.62 (grand total of all events)
  - The Trevor Project
- Influencer communities are often places where abusers actively seek out vulnerable individuals. Having the creator directly stand against those bad actors helps their own brand as well.
- Most widespread platforms for successful influencer to impressionable audience
  - Recent study shows ~27% kids 7-12 list "influencer" as their dream jobs
- Explore sponsored segments content within YouTube videos
  - I.e. BetterHelp YouTuber sponsorships where the creator takes 1 minute to speak about the sponsor
- Explore event-based marketing around Safer Internet Day (Feb 11 annually)
  - Charity livestreams with donation milestones on both platforms

**Paid media (social, ads, search)** allows for precise targeting of the tech-savvy, socially conscious audience while providing various formats to convey the campaign's message effectively. The mix of professional networks, tech-focused platforms, and broader digital channels ensures comprehensive coverage of the target demographic.

### **Co-marketing**

- **Employee Engagement:** Partnering with corporations allows Thorn to tap into employee networks, fostering a community of advocates who are passionate about supporting the cause.
- **Enhanced Visibility:** Corporate partnerships amplify Thorn's reach, introducing the organization to broader audiences and raising awareness about its mission
- **Financial Support:** Businesses can provide direct funding to help expand Thorn's services and initiatives.

## **Tactics Per Channel:** *(Provide a brief strategy for each chosen channel.)*

**SEE PRIMARY CHANNELS SECTION ABOVE FOR COMPREHENSIVE SUMMARY**

## MEASUREMENT

Explain how you will evaluate the campaign's effectiveness.

**Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):** *(What are the success metrics? E.g., Engagement rates, conversion rates, lead generation.)*

Awareness KPIs: Reach, impressions, video views, podcast listens

Engagement KPIs: Social media engagement, avatar creations, content shares

Conversion KPIs: Number of new donors, donation amount, email open and click-through rates, event attendance, total donation amount for event livestreams

Retention KPIs: Donor retention rate, newsletter engagement, community participation

**Expected Outcomes:** *(What impact do you anticipate from this campaign?)*

It is difficult to predict the actual generated revenue from large annual events, especially if the corporate sponsor has not organized one before. It can take even the most successful and largest charity events a few chances to truly become profitable by learning from failure, and should only be pursued as a long-term investment in the growth of the Thorn network.

However, since an all-online event that is relatively inexpensive to promote and prepare for, there is tremendous upside, especially given the volume of revenue generated by similar events in the past. This approach also directly tackles the communities where minors are discovered and exploited by their abusers, and has the potential to get other corporate sponsors such as Meta involved with promotion.

In the long-run, this could turn Thorn into a household name in the digital landscape, further deepen the business relationships with platforms interested in cosponsoring the event, and grow a grassroots community of influencers and users that could be a loyal audience for this event annually.

## ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

Any other factors your team considered in designing this campaign?

- **Potential Challenges & Solutions:** *(Anticipate obstacles and how to overcome them.)*
- **Budget Considerations:** *(If relevant, estimate costs and resource allocation.)*



- **Scalability & Future Plans:** *(How can this campaign be expanded or refined over time?)*

#### Potential Challenges and Solutions

- Influencers can get “canceled” and represent the brand poorly
  - Solution: Properly vet each influencer that will be inducted into the official network, including personal history, and interview how each already try to police their communities
- There’s a risk that the event could not be profitable
  - Solution: The purpose of this event is to build community and brand recognition so that the future ones can be more successful than the previous. Thorn should treat this as a long-term investment, because there is so much upside to this strategy that failing one or twice would still be worth it in the long run.

#### Budget Considerations

- The unique part of this strategy is that it is all **online** and **scalable**. While it may take most of a set budget to run the **media creation, paid search, and sponsored content**, Thorn’s mission and how it can resonate with influencers can create a grassroots effect for free marketing via social media and digital word-of-mouth.

#### Future Plans

- Leverage the creation of a digital avatar into the development of future interactive material
  - Comic/picture book featuring the created avatar that can be read to a child
  - Allegorical plot could involve someone lying to a child in a online forum, the child discovering the lie, telling an adult, and the parents taking action, illustrating what to do if it happens to the child in real life

#### Misc

- Consider working with web developers to create a Google Chrome/Firefox extension to be installed on children’s devices that can dynamically censor curse words, require confirmation for photos, and make reporting options more visible in the UI from the client side without petitioning the various platforms to make those changes themselves.
- Consider working with back-end developers and reaching out to the Discord development team to develop Discord bots, since many abusers use that specific platform to target vulnerable individuals.

## FINAL SUMMARY

Provide a concise summary of why your campaign is the best solution for the challenge.

Our solution is the best because: 1\ This campaign directly targets the root of the problem: children who do the natural thing of engaging with their peers online are often the most vulnerable to exploitation within these communities. 2\ **By getting the very influencers worshiped by these children to take a definitive stand against abusers, all parties win.** 3\ Children are safer, influencers can use it to bolster their brand and secure sponsorships in the future, and Thorn gains the brand recognition and reach for its message.

The all-digital nature of this campaign makes it incredibly flexible and scalable after the initial buy-in. What is stopping the creation of media assets from being reused after paying a designer's fee? The grassroots nature of many of these different campaigns has the added bonus of being able to spread via word-of-mouth and organic social media sharing across a variety of different verticals, hobbies, and industries without investing resources into doing the research and paying to target these specific keywords. Web properties can be leveraged across a variety of platforms and channels, such as SEO-optimized landing pages directly on Thorn's sites and social media campaigns that can have the same content formatted differently to be appropriate for every platform Thorn is already on.

By far the most important aspect for this campaign is promoting the aspects of community. The main goal of this project should not be to generate X amounts of revenue or get Y clicks - it's to raise awareness of a growing epidemic that people are simply unaware of. Community-first approaches have historically been the bread and butter of nonprofits with a mission of public service education and there's no reason Thorn can't follow in that history as well.